UEAB Smart Noticeboard: One-Page Business Model

Team DESHASHERS | ISC Digital Build-Off 2026 | Theme: Campus Problems (notices and communication)

1. CUSTOMER AND PROBLEM

Announcements are scattered across channels, reach students late, and are not filtered by relevance.

- **Primary users:** UEAB students (all four schools).
- **Publishers:** lecturers, departments and administrators who currently repeat the same message across email, WhatsApp, class reps and notice boards.
- **Pain:** in our survey of 43 students, **93%** had missed an announcement and **67%** miss them sometimes or frequently. Only **23%** check email several times a day, and **88%** had attended a physical meeting that could have been a digital notice.

2. SOLUTION AND VALUE

- **Product:** UEAB Smart Noticeboard, one web platform where staff publish official notices and students read and search them.
- **Admin:** create, edit, delete, categorise, draft or publish, and view statistics.
- **Student:** register, log in, browse, search and read notices.
- **Why better:** one official source instead of buried WhatsApp messages; notices are searchable and archived; staff publish once instead of many times.
- **Next (from survey):** department and year targeting, urgent flag, deadlines and notifications.

3. COSTS AND ADOPTION

- **Cost to run:** low. PHP and MySQL on the university server, or shared hosting at an estimated KES 5,000-15,000 per year. Open-source stack, no licence fees.
- **Who sustains it:** the University (ICT or Student Affairs) as an official communication tool; free for students.
- **First 100 users:** (1) pilot with one school and its class reps; (2) departments post official notices there first; (3) BITSA and student leaders promote it; (4) a QR code on existing notice boards links to the site.
- **Success measure:** share of students who say they missed a notice, tracked by repeating our survey.

4. RISKS AND COMPLIANCE

- **Data privacy:** only name, email and role are stored; passwords are hashed. Aligned with the Kenya Data Protection Act, 2019 (consent, minimal data).
- **Security:** prepared SQL statements, session authentication, role-based access and protected admin pages; no secrets in the repository.
- **Adoption risk:** students may keep using WhatsApp. Mitigation: staff publish official notices only here.
- **Access risk:** poor hostel internet, noted by respondents. Mitigation: light, mobile-friendly pages.
- **Content risk:** only authorised staff can publish.

Survey: 43 UEAB respondents, 10-11 Nov 2026 (Business 17, Education/Humanities/Social Sciences 10, Science and Technology 9, Nursing 7). Cost figures are estimates.